準1級

第8回

英検準1級形式

リーディング練習

第8回　｜　部分演習（筆記全体の制限時間は流用しません）　｜　選択問題 31問

■ 出題構成・自己採点記録表

大問	問題番号	出題形式・内容	設問数	自己採点・点検
1	(1)〜(18)	短文の語句空所補充	18問	／18
2	(19)〜(24)	長文の語句空所補充	6問	／6
3	(25)〜(31)	長文の内容一致選択	7問	／7

■ 演習・印刷の手引き

1. 問題冊子には正答や解説を載せていません。解答用紙はA4横マークシート（1ページ）です。
2. 印刷時は「白黒・実際のサイズ（100%）」を選ぶと、マーク欄や英作文罫線が本番見本に近い実寸で出力されます。
3. 解き終わるまでは「解答・解説」を開かず、本番と同じ時間配分を意識して取り組んでください。
4. 同じ選択問題はアプリの「分野別練習」、英作文課題はアプリの「ライティング練習」でも学習・保存できます。

実施日：　　年　　月　　日　　開始〜終了：　　：　　〜　　：

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿　　選択問題 合計：　　／31 点

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1

次の(1)から(18)までの（ ）に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

(1) The pharmaceutical regulator ordered an immediate recall after trace solvents were found to ( ) three batches of eye drops.

1 arbitrate **2** adulate **3** ameliorate **4** adulterate

(2) What began as an ( ) disagreement over parking spaces soon escalated into a bitter lawsuit between the two shopkeepers.

1 insidious **2** innocuous **3** insolent **4** intractable

(3) To ( ) public skepticism about the new water-recycling plant, engineers opened the tasting room to daily citizen tours.

1 annex **2** abet **3** allay **4** avert

(4) The biographer avoided hagiography, offering a ( ) portrait that weighed the diplomat's peacekeeping triumphs alongside his private vanity.

1 nuanced **2** negligent **3** nebulous **4** noisome

(5) Because granite bedrock lies just below the topsoil, digging a deep subway tunnel beneath the district proved prohibitively ( ).

1 ostensible **2** opulent **3** obsequious **4** onerous

(6) When three dry winters depleted mountain reservoirs, the utility urged households to ( ) nonessential garden watering.

1 curtail **2** coddle **3** coalesce **4** conjure

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(7) The conductor's ( ) rehearsals—stopping the orchestra over a sixteenth-note release—paid off in a crystalline performance.

1 erratic **2** exacting **3** ersatz **4** ebullient

(8) Critics argued that subsidizing short domestic flights was ( ) to the government's own pledge to cut transport emissions.

1 amenable **2** ancillary **3** antithetical **4** analogous

(9) Even after retiring from the bench, the former justice remained a ( ) defender of legal aid for low-income tenants.

1 stolid **2** staunch **3** spurious **4** skittish

(10) Because ancient silk banners deteriorate rapidly in oxygen, museum engineers sealed the display case in an ( ) argon atmosphere.

1 inane **2** inept **3** innate **4** inert

(11) The committee's 400-page report was faulted for its ( ) prose, which buried urgent safety recommendations under bureaucratic jargon.

1 turgid **2** tacit **3** terse **4** tractable

(12) Without independent soil testing, the developer's assurances that the former factory lot was clean remained purely ( ).

1 congenial **2** compulsory **3** conjectural **4** culpable

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(13) A sudden freeze in April can (　　) cherry orchards, wiping out open blossoms before bees ever leave their hives.

1 disseminate **2** delineate **3** deprecate **4** decimate

(14) Rather than issue a sweeping ban, city hall adopted a (　　) ordinance tuned to the noise levels of different neighborhoods.

1 callous **2** capricious **3** calibrated **4** circuitous

(15) Years of bipartisan cooperation on harbor dredging began to (　　) once the two coastal counties disputed how to split Federal grants.

1 forge **2** fray **3** fawn **4** foster

(16) Although marketed as revolutionary, the smart kettle's twenty mobile alerts struck most tea drinkers as utterly (　　).

1 superfluous **2** salutary **3** stringent **4** subservient

(17) When coastal fog grounded helicopters, island paramedics had to (　　) a calm fishing cove to transfer the patient by boat.

1 fend off **2** fawn over **3** fizzle out **4** fall back on

(18) The auditor refused to (　　) the missing invoices, insisting that every yen of public grant money be documented before Friday.

1 wade into **2** wink at **3** wean off **4** whittle down

2 A 次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(19)から(21)までの（ ）に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

Daylight and Operable Windows in Hospital Design

During the postwar hospital building boom of the 1960s and 1970s, architects across North America, Europe, and Japan embraced deep-plan "megahospitals"—vast air-conditioned blocks in which operating theaters, laboratories, and nursing stations sat far from exterior walls. Mechanical ventilation promised sterile temperature control, and clustering rooms tightly cut walking distances between departments. Yet within a generation, clinicians and patients alike began noticing the human cost of sealed, windowless interiors.

Chronobiology—the study of internal biological clocks—helped explain why. Human hormone cycles, sleep depth, and immune responses depend on strong morning blue-spectrum daylight followed by genuine darkness at night. Patients recovering in dim interior rooms or wards lit around the clock by uniform fluorescent tubes often experience disrupted circadian rhythms, post-surgical delirium, and longer stays. Observational studies even found that surgical patients assigned to bright east-facing rooms needed measurably less pain medication than peers facing shaded brick walls. (***19***), nurses working twelve-hour shifts without a view of sky or greenery reported higher rates of burnout and medication-charting fatigue.

Contemporary hospital design has therefore swung toward narrower floor plates, landscaped courtyards, and dynamic lighting. By folding wards around interior gardens, architects ensure every bed sits near natural daylight and views of trees without sacrificing proximity between clinical teams. High-infection rooms still rely on sealed HEPA filtration, of course. (***20***), ordinary recovery rooms in several newer European clinics incorporate secure, narrow-vent windows that let convalescing patients feel fresh breeze when outdoor air quality permits.

Architecture alone does not cure illness, yet aligning hospital geometry with human physiology helps healthcare systems (***21***).

(19) **1** Otherwise **2** On the contrary **3** Likewise **4** Thankfully

(20) **1** At the same time **2** Consequently **3** In vain **4** For instance

(21)

1 double the length of nurses' walking corridors

2 replace all surgical equipment with courtyard gardens

3 seal every hospital room away from morning sunlight

4 support faster patient recovery alongside staff resilience

2 B 次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(22)から(24)までの（ ）に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

The Quiet Economics of Repairable Appliances

For much of the twentieth century, buying a household washing machine, toaster, or electric fan meant acquiring an object expected to outlast a decade—and to visit a neighborhood repair bench if a switch or belt wore out. Over the past thirty years, however, falling manufacturing costs and sleeker industrial design shifted consumer electronics and small appliances toward sealed enclosures held together with permanent adhesives rather than standard screws.

Manufacturers defend glued assemblies on legitimate engineering grounds: thinner cases weigh less, water seals are easier to certify, and automated assembly lines run faster without dozens of threaded fasteners. Yet sealed construction alters the economics of ownership dramatically. When a three-hundred-yen rubber gasket or lithium cell degrades inside a welded plastic housing, opening the unit takes forty minutes of prying and risks cracking the casing. Labor charges quickly exceed the price of a brand-new replacement. (***22***), millions of otherwise functional motors and circuit boards enter waste streams prematurely every year.

Policy makers in the European Union and several U.S. states have responded with "right-to-repair" mandates requiring firms to publish service manuals, avoid proprietary screw heads where standard ones work, and stock common spare parts for seven to ten years after a model leaves production. Early industry fears that repairability rules would freeze innovation have largely proved overstated. Modular smartphones and front-access washing machines show that thoughtful industrial design can keep water out while still letting technicians swap worn components in ten minutes. (***23***), independent repair shops gain steady local employment that cannot be offshored.

Designing products to be opened and mended does not mean abandoning sleek engineering; rather, it asks manufacturers to (***24***).

(22) **1** Inevitably **2** Conversely **3** Thankfully **4** Until recently

(23) **1** Otherwise **2** Furthermore **3** Instead **4** Nevertheless

(24)

1 outlaw automatic assembly lines in appliance factories

2 glue every battery permanently onto glass screens

3 treat long-term maintainability as a core measure of product quality

4 charge ten times more for a rubber gasket than a new machine

3 A 次の英文の内容に関して、(25)から(27)までの質問に対する答えとして最も適切なもの、または文を完成させるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

Reading Ancient Droughts in Cave Stalagmites

Tree rings offer a wonderfully precise annual calendar of past rainfall, yet wood rarely survives intact for more than a few thousand years, and vast tropical regions contain tree species that form no distinct seasonal rings at all. When paleoclimatologists want to reconstruct monsoon failures across tens of thousands of years—spanning ice ages and the rise of early farming—they increasingly descend into limestone caves to study stalagmites rising from the cavern floor.

Stalagmites grow drop by drop as rainwater percolates through soil and limestone fissures before dripping onto the cave floor and depositing thin mineral rings of calcium carbonate, much like vertical tree trunks made of stone. Crucially, each microscopic layer locks in the chemical signature of the rain that fell above. Heavy monsoon downpours contain slightly higher proportions of lighter oxygen isotopes than sparse drought showers; by drilling pinhead-sized powder samples along a sliced stalagmite's central axis, geochemists can track wet and dry decades with startling clarity. Even better, trace uranium trapped in the crystal decays into thorium at a known nuclear rate, letting labs date individual stone layers back half a million years within margins of just a few decades.

Reading cave stone still demands caution. Water seeping through complex rock fractures can mix rainfall from several seasons or follow shifting drips, making a single stalagmite an imperfect mirror of the sky unless cross-checked against neighboring formations in the same region. When multiple caves across Asia or Mesoamerica record the same abrupt century-long drying, however, historians gain hard physical evidence for climate stresses that coincided with ancient dynastic upheavals.

3A Reading Ancient Droughts in Cave Stalagmites 設問 (25)〜(27)

(25) What two limitations of tree-ring records motivate paleoclimatologists to study cave stalagmites?

1 Tree rings cannot detect rainfall at all and require volcanic ash to date.

2 Wood seldom endures beyond several millennia, and many tropical trees lack clear annual rings.

3 Limestone caves exist in every city park whereas trees grow only on mountains.

4 Tree rings record ocean salinity rather than land precipitation.

(26) How are laboratories able to determine the age of individual mineral layers inside a stalagmite so accurately?

1 By counting fossilized leaves trapped between stone layers.

2 By weighing how much rainwater drips onto the cave floor in one afternoon.

3 By comparing the stone's color against nineteenth-century photographs.

4 By measuring the steady radioactive decay of trace uranium into thorium.

(27) Why must researchers cross-check a stalagmite's record against other formations in the same region?

1 Groundwater pathways through rock fissures can blend seasons or shift drip points in a single formation.

2 Uranium isotopes vanish completely whenever monsoon rains return.

3 Cave tourists frequently polish stalagmites with sandpaper.

4 Single stalagmites record temperatures only from the Southern Hemisphere.

3 B 次の英文の内容に関して、(28)から(31)までの質問に対する答えとして最も適切なもの、または文を完成させるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

The Subtle Pitfalls of Algorithmic Dynamic Pricing

Airlines and hotels have adjusted fares according to season and remaining capacity for half a century; travelers readily accept that a beach room costs more in August than in rainy November, or that booking a seat the night before departure carries a premium. Powered by real-time inventory software and electronic shelf labels, however, rapid "dynamic pricing" has begun spreading into everyday arenas—from commuter toll lanes and ride-hailing apps to concert tickets, restaurant menus, and even neighborhood supermarkets.

In textbook microeconomics, flexible prices allocate scarce goods efficiently. Raising ride-hail fares during a Friday downpour entices off-duty drivers onto the streets while nudging price-sensitive riders with umbrellas toward the subway, shrinking wait times for people with urgent trips. Similarly, automated markdowns on yogurt or fish approaching its sell-by date at seven p.m. curb food waste while rewarding thrifty evening shoppers.

Yet behavioral economists warn that treating every consumer transaction like a live stock exchange overlooks how deeply long-term retail relationships depend on perceived fairness. In classic surveys pioneered by Daniel Kahneman and colleagues, respondents judged it acceptable for a hardware store to discontinue a seasonal discount when snow shovels ran low, yet overwhelmingly condemned raising the regular price of shovels the morning after a blizzard. Consumers distinguish sharply between rationing scarce luxuries and exploiting sudden necessity.

Opaque algorithms compound that resentment when prices jump unpredictably within minutes or appear personalized to a shopper's battery level or postcode. Firms chasing short-term surge revenue in staple goods have repeatedly suffered reputational backlashes far costlier than the extra margin earned on a busy afternoon. Smart pricing design therefore pairs transparency and clear upper caps with genuine customer value—using discounts to smooth off-peak demand rather than ambushing captive buyers.

3B The Subtle Pitfalls of Algorithmic Dynamic Pricing 設問 (28)〜(31)

(28) According to the second paragraph, how can dynamic pricing produce socially useful outcomes in specific settings?

1 By keeping ride-hail fares frozen during Friday rainstorms so drivers stay home.

2 By throwing away unsold fish before seven p.m. to protect brand prestige.

3 By matching supply and urgent demand during peak crunches and cutting grocery waste via automated markdowns.

4 By charging subway passengers higher fares whenever they carry umbrellas.

(29) What distinction in consumer fairness judgments did surveys by Daniel Kahneman and colleagues reveal?

1 Shoppers prefer paying higher prices for snow shovels after blizzards.

2 Hardware stores lose customers whenever they offer seasonal discounts.

3 Consumers view airline tickets and bread as identical luxury items.

4 People accept ending a promotion when stock is low, but resent raising regular prices to exploit sudden need.

(30) What risk do retailers of staple goods run when they use opaque algorithms to capture short-term surge profits?

1 Their electronic shelf labels run out of electricity within hours.

2 Regulators force them to become airlines or hotels.

3 They risk severe damage to customer trust and reputation that outweighs brief revenue gains.

4 Off-peak shoppers refuse to accept evening markdowns on yogurt.

(31) What approach to flexible pricing does the author recommend at the end of the passage?

1 Banning all seasonal discounts at hotels and concert halls.

2 Combining transparency and clear price caps with off-peak discounts rather than exploiting captive buyers.

3 Adjusting prices secretly based on each customer's phone battery level.

4 Changing supermarket bread prices every thirty seconds during rush hour.